

over the current version while largely maintaining the existing syntax and API. The future looks promising for PHP.

Show me the code

The first entry to any programming language starts with a 'Hello world' program. Here is how it looks in PHP:

- ```
<?php echo "Hello World"; ?>
```

But that is too simple. Right? Let's try to print something little more interesting:

- ```
<?php
```
- ```
$x = 5;
```
- ```
$x_square = $x * $x;
```
- ```
$result = "The square of $x is: " . $x_square;
```
- ```
echo $result;
```
- ```
?>
```

This small program shows a good deal of features of PHP which make web development easy. The output of this program is:

- ```
Value of $x is 5 The square of 5 is: 25
```

Line 2 shows how you can dynamically declare a variable and assign it a value. Notice that there is no data type for the variable. Data type is automatically determined.

Line 3 shows you can perform simple mathematical operations as easily as you do in any other programming language. Once again, creating the variable is dynamic.

Line 4 shows that a string can be concatenated (using the '.' operator) with an integer (\$x) and printed on screen without any effort. PHP does the type conversion for display so you do not have to worry about it.

Line 5 shows that inside a double quoted string, a variable is evaluated before printing. Also, concatenation of a string and an integer can be stored into a variable and the resulting variable can be printed (line 6) and will be shown without an error.

Isn't it interesting?

Let's move to creating an array, sort it and display it: